

BLUE-AND-YELLOW MACAWS ARE NOT ENDANGERED, BUT THEIR NUMBERS ARE DECLINING DUE TO SHRINKING HABITATS



MACAWS ARE HIGHLY PRIZED AS PETS, LEADING POACHERS TO TARGET THESE BIRDS AND SELL THEM ILLEGALLY

Flooded forests

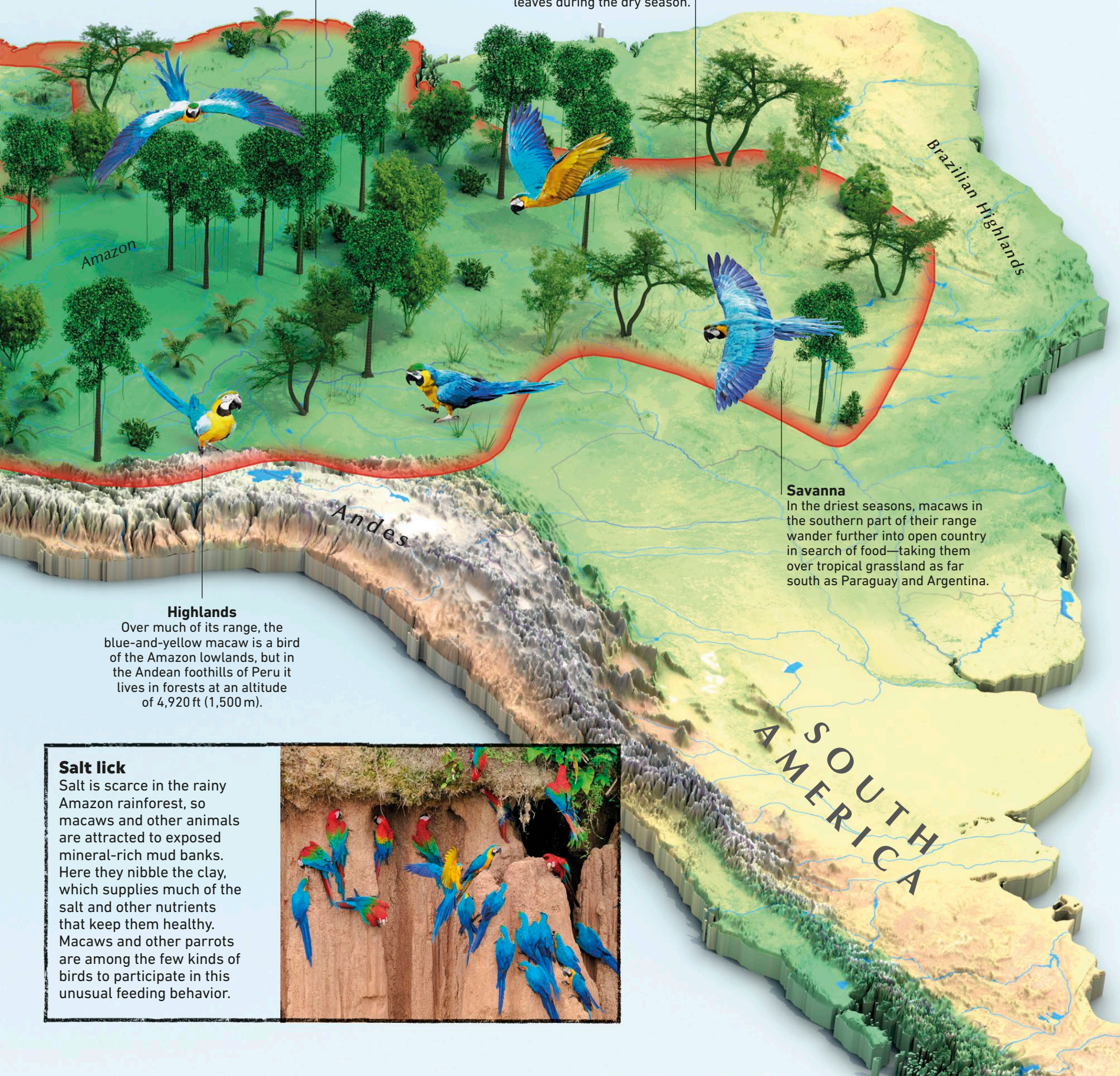
In the central Amazon, the blue-and-yellow macaw lives in a type of forest called várzea. This region gets flooded during the rainy season, but the birds can stay feeding in the canopy high above the rising waters.

Dry forests

In some parts of its range, the blue-and-yellow macaw lives in woodlands very different from the wet rainforest. Here, the trees are deciduous and lose their leaves during the dry season.

KEY

 Blue-and-yellow macaw range



Highlands

Over much of its range, the blue-and-yellow macaw is a bird of the Amazon lowlands, but in the Andean foothills of Peru it lives in forests at an altitude of 4,920 ft (1,500 m).

Salt lick

Salt is scarce in the rainy Amazon rainforest, so macaws and other animals are attracted to exposed mineral-rich mud banks. Here they nibble the clay, which supplies much of the salt and other nutrients that keep them healthy. Macaws and other parrots are among the few kinds of birds to participate in this unusual feeding behavior.

